St. Genevieve Community Church

Adult Education Series - Fall 2026
"Living with the Gospels"
Tuesday Evenings, 7:30 to 9:00 PM | Parish Education Room
Facilitator: Rev. Colette Mullins

Course Description

This seven week course invites participants to encounter the Gospel texts not as relics of the past but as living documents that address our circumstances today. Each session combines close reading of the text, historical context, theological reflection, and practical application.

Required Text: A Study Bible with the New Revised Standard Version (NRSV) translation. No purchase required, copies are available in the parish library.

Session Schedule

Week 1 - October 6, 2026

Topic: The Gospel of Mark: Urgency and Action

Reading: Mark 1:1-45

Why does Mark begin with the word immediately? The compressed urgency of the earliest Gospel account and what it demands of us.

Week 2 - October 13, 2026

Topic: The Gospel of Luke: Good News for the Poor

Reading: Luke 4:14-30; 6:17-49

Luke's particular concern for the marginalized. The Beatitudes in Luke's version compared with Matthew's. Implications for parish social ministry.

Week 3 - October 20, 2026

Topic: The Parables: Difficult Stories

Reading: Luke 15:1-32; Matthew 20:1-16

The prodigal son and the workers in the vineyard. Why parables disturb rather than comfort, and why that is exactly the point.

Week 4 - October 27, 2026

Topic: The Sermon on the Mount

Reading: Matthew 5:1-7:29

A sustained engagement with the Beatitudes and the ethical demands of discipleship. Bonhoeffer's reading in The Cost of Discipleship will be discussed.

Week 5 - November 3, 2026

Topic: Resurrection Narratives

Reading: Mark 16; Luke 24; John 20

The empty tomb stories differ, and that matters. What the variations tell us about how the first communities processed the resurrection experience.

Week 6 - November 10, 2026
Topic: Prayer Practices in the Gospels

Reading: Matthew 6:5-15; Luke 11:1-13; John 17

The Lord's Prayer in context. Contemplative and intercessory traditions in the Gospels. Connecting Daily Office practice to Gospel roots.

Week 7 - November 17, 2026
Topic: The Eucharist: Then and Now

Reading: Luke 22:14-20; John 6:25-71; 1 Corinthians 11:23-26

The Last Supper accounts and the development of Eucharistic theology. Why the table is the center of Christian life.

Registration not required. Childcare available with 48 hours notice. Contact bklein@stgenevievecle.org.